

Kenneth N. Lopes

klopes23@gmail.com | (401) 580-7850 | Los Angeles, CA | www.kennethlopes.com

SUMMARY

- Senior Technical Program Manager driving hardware, software, cloud, and operations programs from requirements through launch and manufacturing readiness, across **\$15M/yr portfolios, 5 countries, and 100+ contributors**.
- Builds the operating system around delivery — stage-gates, Agile cadences, readiness reviews, and executive reporting — and stands up AI operations (RAG plus human-in-the-loop workflows and GenAI adoption dashboards) that drive cost-avoidance, faster cycle times, and measurable productivity gains.

EXPERIENCE

Canoga Perkins, Los Angeles, CA

April 2023 – March 2026

Program Manager

- **Avoided ~\$0.9M/yr in costs** by establishing a single plan-of-record across 5 sites (India, Singapore, Ukraine, Pakistan, Greater LA) and driving 4,700+ GitLab issues to closure via weekly risk and dependency reviews with clear ownership.
- **Uncovered \$1M+ in procurement savings** by capturing AI workflows across enterprise-resource-planning (ERP)-adjacent purchasing, then operationalized a SharePoint-backed retrieval-augmented-generation (RAG) plus human-in-the-loop (HITL) workflow that cut manual work 60% and generated \$85K in verified savings.
- **Increased weekly active users (WAU) 193%** by designing a cross-functional AI adoption program — intake-to-execution workflow, communications cadence, training assets, success metrics, and operational reporting — that standardized rollout and scaled adoption across engineering, operations, and support teams.
- **Led 8 cross-functional (XFN) teams** across 50+ engineers (hardware, firmware, software, manufacturing, QA) to deliver a software-defined data-center switch from requirements to general availability (GA) in 31 months, cutting time-to-market 13% with standardized governance, milestones, and executive reporting.
- **Reduced new-product-introduction (NPI) lead time 18%** by onboarding contract manufacturer Sanmina (EMS/3PL) and enforcing stage-gates (requirements/EVT/DVT/PVT) through service-level agreements (SLAs), statement-of-work milestones, build-readiness gates, and a program RAID log reviewed weekly.
- **Improved ticket closure ~20%** by delivering a cloud-native network-management system (NMS) — topology, discovery, provisioning — and tightening role-based access control (RBAC) and multi-factor authentication (MFA); owned backlog, sprints, and releases with acceptance criteria and cross-team dependency tracking.

Promotion Plus, Los Angeles, CA

September 2021 – April 2023

Project Manager, Brand Programs

- **Improved program timelines 22%** by streamlining permitting and vendor/general-contractor (GC) coordination across 50+ multi-site rollouts for national fuel retailers (Shell, Chevron, 76).
- Led client approval cycles with brand managers and stakeholders, ensuring redesigns met brand standards and site-specific sizing and compliance constraints while coordinating internal design, vendors, and field execution.

The Nesi Family, Los Angeles, CA

January 2015 – Present

Founder & Creator Operations

- Scaled a father-son creator brand from 0 to **910K+ followers and 100M+ views** across TikTok, Instagram, Snapchat, YouTube, and Facebook — all 100% organic at \$0 in paid promotion.
- Drove **+62% revenue lift** across national brand partnerships (Domino's, P.F. Chang's) by building Creator Operations as a scalable support function — intake, SLAs/TTR, KPI dashboards, and escalation paths for brief-to-publish execution.
- Defined and shipped a 6-page AI-assisted web product from concept to launch using Claude Code as an agentic development partner — owning product requirements, UX direction, QA, deployment readiness, SEO/structured data, and launch measurement across ~10 days and 30+ pull requests on auto-deploy CI.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sungrade Solar, Los Angeles, CA

2018 – 2021

Project Manager

- **Cut project cycle time 31%** (8 → 5.5 weeks) across 125+ residential installs by aligning sales, operations, and field teams and removing inspection bottlenecks from contract to permission-to-operate (PTO).
- **Raised inspection pass rate from 60% to 87%** by coordinating early with authorities-having-jurisdiction (AHJs) and city inspectors to clear permitting and inspection gates before install.

Scoobeez Inc., Los Angeles, CA

2015 – 2018

Operations Manager

- Launched a 6-city Amazon Prime Now fulfillment operation by onboarding **400+ drivers** and building repeatable onboarding and training infrastructure to scale daily operations across markets.
- **Reduced no-shows 33%** by building a custom time-tracking and scheduling mobile app that improved coverage reliability and operational consistency across all delivery sites.

EDUCATION

University of Rhode Island, Kingston, RI

Sept 2010 – May 2015

B.A., Communication Studies & Business Marketing

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner · AWS Certified AI Practitioner · Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) · Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) · PMP Candidate (Expected Q3 2026)

KEY SKILLS

Program Governance & Delivery: Technical Program Management (TPM) · Program Governance · End-to-End Delivery · Roadmap Planning · Backlog Grooming · RAID & Decision Logs · Dependency Mgmt · Stakeholder Mgmt · Cross-Functional Leadership · Executive Reporting · OKRs · Stage-Gate (EVT/DVT/PVT)

Hardware/Software/Firmware Integration: New Product Introduction (NPI) · HW/SW/FW Integration · Systems Engineering · FPGA/Embedded Coordination · Systems Software · CI/CD · GitLab · Release Mgmt · Manufacturing Readiness · Prototype → Production

Operations & Scale: Contract Manufacturing (EMS) · Vendor Mgmt · Multi-Site Rollouts · Supply Chain · Procurement · Order-to-Cash · ERP · BOM · PLM Change Control · KPI Dashboards · SQL

AI / Automation: Generative AI · AI Copilots · RAG · Prompt Engineering · Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) Workflows · Workflow Automation · Knowledge Base (SharePoint) · Requirements Documentation · SOP Development

Quality & Compliance: ISO 9001 · TL 9000 · Regulatory Compliance · RoHS · EMC/EMI/ESD · NEBS · Environmental & Safety Standards

Tools: Jira · Confluence · Smartsheet · SharePoint · Miro · GitLab · Notion · Google Sheets/Excel · Claude · ChatGPT · Figma · Adobe Creative Suite